Practical 3: Customising Your CRD

Day 2 — Duration: 1.5 Hours

SDI Training for ICT Professionals — Climate Risk Database

What you will accomplish: By the end of this practical, your CRD will have your institution's name, a custom logo, user accounts, and a default map centred on your region. Almost everything is done through the web browser — very little terminal work is needed.

Before you start: Your CRD must be running from Practical 2. Open your browser and go to `http://localhost` to confirm it loads. If it does not load, go back to your terminal and run: `docker compose up -d` from inside the `my-crd` folder.

Step 1: Log in to the Admin Panel

Step 1.1: Open your web browser and go to:

```
http://localhost/admin/
```

What this does: Opens the Django administration panel — the "control room" for your CRD where you manage all settings.

You should see: A login page with the title "Django administration" and fields for username and password.

Step 1.2: Enter the admin username and password you created in Practical 2 (Step 9) and click **"Log in"**.

You should see: The admin dashboard — a page listing many sections like "Authentication and Authorization", "GeoNode", "Sites", and more. This is where all platform configuration happens.

Tip: Bookmark `http://localhost/admin/` in your browser. You will visit this page often during the training.

Step 2: Change the Site Name

By default, your CRD is called "example.com". Let us change it to your institution's name.

Step 2.1: On the admin dashboard, scroll down and find the section called **"Sites"**.

Step 2.2: Click on **"Sites"**.

You should see: A list with one entry: `example.com`.

Step 2.3: Click on **"example.com"** to edit it.

Step 2.4: Change the two fields:

- **Domain name:** Type `localhost`
- **Display name:** Type your institution's name, for example: `Tanga City Resilience Dashboard` or `Mwanza Urban CRD`

Step 2.5: Click the **"Save"** button at the bottom.

You should see: A green success message: "The site 'localhost' was changed successfully."

Step 2.6: Open a new tab and go to `http://localhost`. Refresh the page.

You should see: The homepage now shows your institution's name instead of "GeoNode" or "example.com" in the page title and header area.

Step 3: Upload a Logo

You can replace the default GeoNode logo with your institution's logo.

Step 3.1: First, prepare your logo file:

- The logo should be a **PNG** or **JPEG** file
- Recommended size: **200 x 60 pixels** (wide rectangle)
- If you do not have a logo, you can use the training logo provided by the instructor

Step 3.2: In the admin panel (`http://localhost/admin/`), look for **"Base"** section and click on **"Configuration"** (or navigate to the GeoNode settings).

Step 3.3: Alternatively, go to the GeoNode front-end. Click on your username (top-right) → **"Admin"**.

Step 3.4: Navigate to **Home** → **Base** → **Configuration**. Look for the logo or branding settings.

Step 3.5: If logo upload is available through the admin interface, click **"Choose File"**, select your logo, and click **"Save"**.

> **Alternative method using the file system:** If the admin interface does not have a logo upload option, you can copy a logo file directly into the container. Open your terminal and run:

```
docker compose cp my-logo.png django:/opt/geonode/geonode/static/img/logo.png
```

What this does: Copies your logo file from your laptop into the Django container, placing it in the static images folder where GeoNode looks for the logo.

You should see: No output (silence means success).

Then collect the static files so the change takes effect:

```
docker compose exec django python manage.py collectstatic --noinput
```

What this does: Tells GeoNode to gather all static files (images, CSS, JavaScript) and make them available to the web server.

You should see: A message like "X static files copied to '/mnt/volumes/statics/static'."

Step 3.6: Refresh your browser. Your logo should now appear on the CRD homepage.

Step 4: Create User Accounts

You will create accounts for team members who will use the CRD.

Step 4.1: In the admin panel, find the **"People"** section (or **"Authentication and Authorization"** → **"Users"**).

Step 4.2: Click **"Users"** (or **"+ Add"** next to Users).

Step 4.3: Click the **"Add user +"** button in the top-right corner.

Step 4.4: Fill in the account details for your first team member:

- **Username:** `john.doe` (use a simple name, no spaces)
- **Password:** Enter a password and confirm it

Step 4.5: Click **"Save"**.

You should see: A page with more fields for the user. You can fill in:

- **First name:** John
- **Last name:** Doe
- **Email address:** john.doe@example.com
- **Staff status:** Leave unchecked (only admins need this)
- **Active:** Make sure this is checked

Step 4.6: Click **"Save"** again.

Step 4.7: Repeat Steps 4.2–4.6 to create 2 more user accounts (use names of people at your table or fictional names).

User roles explained:

- **Regular user:** Can view public data, upload data (if permitted), and create maps
- **Staff user:** Can access the admin panel but with limited permissions
- **Superuser:** Full control over everything (this is your admin account)

Step 5: Set the Default Map Centre

When users open the map on your CRD, it should zoom to your region instead of showing the whole world.

Step 5.1: You will need to edit a configuration file. Open your terminal and run:

```
docker compose exec django python manage.py shell -c "
from geonode.base.models import Configuration
config = Configuration.load()
print('Current centre:', config.default_map_center_x, config.default_map_center_y)
print('Current zoom:', config.default_map_zoom)
"
```

What this does: Opens a Python shell inside the Django container and prints the current default map centre coordinates and zoom level.

You should see: The current centre coordinates (likely 0, 0 — the middle of the Atlantic Ocean) and a zoom level.

Step 5.2: Set the default map centre to your region. Choose one of these:

For Tanga:

```
docker compose exec django python manage.py shell -c "
from geonode.base.models import Configuration
config = Configuration.load()
config.default_map_center_x = 39.0957
config.default_map_center_y = -5.0689
config.default_map_zoom = 12
config.save()
print('Map centre set to Tanga!')
```

```
"
```

For Mwanza:

```
docker compose exec django python manage.py shell -c "
from geonode.base.models import Configuration
config = Configuration.load()
config.default_map_center_x = 32.9000
config.default_map_center_y = -2.5164
config.default_map_zoom = 12
config.save()
print('Map centre set to Mwanza!')
"
```

What this does: Updates the database with new coordinates for the default map view. The `x` value is longitude (east-west) and `y` is latitude (north-south). Zoom level 12 shows a city-level view.

You should see: "Map centre set to Tanga!" (or Mwanza).

Step 5.3: Refresh your CRD homepage at `http://localhost`.

You should see: The map on the homepage is now centred on your chosen city.

> **How to find coordinates for any location:** Open Google Maps, right-click on any point, and click the coordinates that appear. The first number is latitude (Y), the second is longitude (X).

Step 6: Configure Registration Settings

You can control whether new users can register themselves or if only administrators can create accounts.

Step 6.1: In the admin panel at `http://localhost/admin/`, look for **"Account"** or **"People"** settings.

Step 6.2: Navigate to **"Configuration"** under the GeoNode/Base section.

Step 6.3: Look for registration-related settings:

- **Registration open:** Check this box if you want anyone to create an account. Uncheck it if only admins should create accounts.
- **Approval required:** If checked, new registrations must be approved by an admin before the account becomes active.

Step 6.4: For training purposes, we recommend:

- **Registration open:** Checked (so participants can register)
- **Approval required:** Unchecked (to keep things simple)

Step 6.5: Click **"Save"**.

Step 6.6: Test it: Open a private/incognito browser window, go to `http://localhost`, and look for a **"Register"** or **"Sign up"** link. Click it and try creating a test account.

You should see: A registration form where new users can enter their details. After registering, they should be able to log in.

Step 7: Set Layer Permission Defaults

Permissions control who can view, download, and edit data on your CRD. Setting good defaults saves time.

Step 7.1: In the admin panel, navigate to **"GeoNode"** → **"Configuration"** or look for **"Default Permissions"** settings.

Step 7.2: Configure the default permissions for newly uploaded layers:

- **Anyone can view:** Recommended to check this for public data platforms
- **Anyone can download:** Check this if you want open data sharing
- **Only the owner can edit:** Recommended — prevents accidental changes

Step 7.3: Click **"Save"**.

> **These are just defaults.** When uploading data, users can always change permissions for individual layers. Setting good defaults means less work for each upload.

Step 7.4: To verify, go to the main CRD site at `http://localhost`. Navigate to **Data** → **Layers**. If there are any layers, click one and check the **"Share"** or **"Permissions"** section.

Checkpoint

Before proceeding to Practical 4, confirm:

☐ **Site name changed:** The CRD homepage shows your institution's name

☐ **Logo uploaded:** Your logo (or the training logo) appears on the site

☐ **User accounts created:** At least 2 additional user accounts exist

☐ **Map centred:** The default map view shows your region (Tanga or Mwanza)

☐ **Registration configured:** Registration is open (or closed, as you prefer)

☐ **Permissions set:** Default layer permissions are configured

> **Excellent!** Your CRD now has a professional appearance with your institution's branding. In the next practical, you will upload real geographic data to your platform.

End of Practical 3 — Proceed to Practical 4: Uploading Data to CRD